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Introduction

- Medicine registration ensures the safety, efficacy, and quality of pharmaceutical products for the public.
- The Ethiopian Food and Drug Authority (EFDA) is the sole government body responsible for regulatory oversight.
- EFDA reviews, approves, and licenses human and veterinary medicines, medical devices, and food supplements.
- Proclamation No. 1112/2019 decrees that EFDA's Marketing Authorization (MA) is legally mandatory

Introduction

- Applications must be submitted by a registered Local Agent using the international Common Technical Document (CTD) format.
- The EFDA employs pathways including Routine Assessment, Fast-Track for priority products, and Regulatory Reliance for expedited review.
- Approval follows submission, screening, scientific evaluation, and usually a Good Manufacturing Practice (GMP) Inspection.

Overview of Ethiopian Medicine Registration

- The Ethiopian Food and Drug Authority (EFDA) is responsible for reviewing and approving medicines before they are used in the country.
- Ensures medicines meet quality and safety standards
- Evaluates applications from manufacturers
- Works according to national regulations

Scope of the Registration Guideline

- The guideline applies to medicines used for human treatment, including:
- Generic medicines
- Innovator or brand-name products
- Medicines made from synthetic and semi-synthetic ingredients
- Products like vaccines and biologicals are covered under separate frameworks.

How the Registration System Works?

- EFDA handles medicine registration through the Medical Product Registration Directorate.
- Uses an online submission system (eRIS)
- Reviews product quality, labeling, safety data, and manufacturing practices
- May ask applicants to clarify or update submitted information

Key Documents Used in Registration

- The registration process relies on several important documents:
- National laws defining EFDA's authority
- EFDA medicine registration guideline
- Marketing authorization requirements
- Good Manufacturing Practice (GMP) standards
- These documents help maintain a consistent and reliable review process.

Ethiopian Medicine Registration Mandate

Mandating Laws

- Food & Medicine Administration Proclamation **No. 1112/2019**
- EFDA Establishment Regulation **No. 531/2023**
- Medicine Marketing Authorization Directive **No. 963/2023**

Scope of EFDA Mandate

Products Covered

- Synthetic & semi-synthetic APIs
- Finished Pharmaceutical Products (FPPs)
- Multisource (generic) & innovator medicines
- Medicines registered by reliance on WHO-listed authorities

Cont...

Products Not Covered

- Vaccines
- Biotherapeutic and Similar Biotherapeutic Products
(These follow their own specialized EFDA guidelines)

Regulatory Obligations

- All applicants must use the EFDA **eRIS online system**
- Submission must follow **Common Technical Document (CTD)** format

Mandated Evaluation Pathways

- **Routine Assessment** – full technical review.
- **Regulatory Reliance** – abbreviated review for products approved by reference authorities (e.g., WHO PQ, stringent regulatory authorities).
- **Low-Risk Product Procedure** – simplified pathway for low-risk medicines.

Cont..

- **Non-Routine/Emergency Pathway**
 - Conditional approval or Emergency Use Authorization for public health emergencies.
- **Fast-Track/Priority Pathway**
 - HIV, TB, malaria, cancer, MNCH products, vaccines, hepatitis medicines, new drugs, orphan diseases, and locally manufactured products.

Mandate After Registration

Registration Validity & Maintenance

- Marketing Authorization valid for **5 years**.
- Mandatory re-registration before expiry.
- Any changes require approval under EFDA's **variation guideline**.

EFDA's Enforcement Mandate

- Reject, suspend, or revoke authorizations based on safety, efficacy, or quality concerns.
- Ensure full traceability through **barcoding requirements**.

Procedure

Before log in to the system, you must have the following in place:

- **Local Agent Appointment:** foreign manufacturers *cannot* register products directly. They must appoint a **Local Agent**.
- **Agency Agreement:** You must sign a legal agreement with this agent. This document must be authenticated by the Ethiopian Embassy in the country of origin or the Ministry of Foreign Affairs in Ethiopia.

Cont...

- **i-License Account:** The local agent must have a valid competency license and an account on the **i-License** portal of the EFDA.

The Registration Process

1. Submission (i-Register)

The Local Agent logs into the **i-Register** portal (part of eRIS).

They upload the CTD dossier (PDF files) and fill in the product details.

2. Screening (Pre-Assessment)

EFDA assessors check if the dossier is complete. If documents (like the GMP cert) are missing or expired, the application is returned immediately.

Cont...

3. Evaluation

- **Primary Review:** Specialized assessors review the scientific data (safety, efficacy, and quality).
- **Lab Analysis:** The agent may be asked to submit physical samples of the medicine to the EFDA Quality Control Laboratory in Addis Ababa for testing.

4. GMP Inspection

- If the factory has never been inspected by the EFDA, a team of Ethiopian inspectors may need to fly to the manufacturing site to conduct a GMP Inspection.

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- *Exemption:* If the product is approved by a Stringent Regulatory Authority (like US FDA, EMA) or is WHO Pre-qualified, the EFDA may waive the physical inspection under "Reliance" pathways.

5. Approval & Certification

- Once the evaluation, lab test, and inspection are passed, the EFDA issues a Marketing Authorization Certificate.
- **Validity:** The certificate is valid for 5 years.

Conclusion

- The Ethiopian medicine registration process is vital for public health, ensuring that all drugs sold within the country meet high standards of safety, quality, and efficacy.
- Key challenges include resource constraints, slow processing times, and a need for better regulatory tools. However, recent improvements indicate a positive trend towards a more efficient and effective regulatory landscape.

Reference

1. Guideline for Registration of Medicine

Thank you !